



members, both permanent and contractual staff.

Gursaurabh mentions that finding mechanical engineers and R&D resources has been

challenging. Despite initial struggles in marketing, the startup has capitalised on its global popularity across social media platforms to overcome these hurdles.

The startup plans to expand its manufacturing operations and scale up to sell millions of units monthly.

—Nitisha Dubey

2 STARYA MOBILITY: SHIFTING GEARS FROM DEVELOPING MOTORS TOWARDS RETROFITTING

Starya Mobility, a Bengaluru-based startup, evolved from developing EV components to retrofitting scooters, is adapting to India's dynamic electric vehicle market.

Starya Mobility, established in 2018 by co-founders including CEO Ravi Kumar and CTO Gowrav, has evolved from focusing on developing motors and controllers for new electric vehicles (EVs) to specialising in retrofitting existing ones. With its headquarters in Bengaluru and a workforce of 65-70 employees, the company has pivoted towards retrofitting, showcasing its capabilities with the successful transformation of an Activa scooter. This strategic shift was driven by the co-founders' passion for vehicles and technology, mainly influenced by the high costs associated with new EVs.

Initially focused on creating affordable electric solutions without compromising quality, Starya Mobility now offers retrofitting services for select scooter models, such as the Activa, priced between ₹55,000 and ₹89,000, depending on the model's power. The retrofitting process includes a thorough scooter evaluation, multiple retrofit options, required RTO inspections and approvals, conversions at Starya's facility, and rigorous quality checks to ensure safety and compatibility.

Their retrofit kits include permanent magnet synchronous (PMS) motors and controllers designed



Starya Mobility and Exedy Clutch India teams

around field-oriented control (FOC) technology, ensuring efficiency and reliability. These components, along with a robust warranty system covering various parts like the battery, motor, and controller, underline the company's commitment to quality.

Starya's business model covers vehicle retrofitting as well as post-conversion servicing and maintenance, all managed in line with government regulations. The process also includes legal disposal of internal combustion engine parts through authorised dealers.

The company's growth strategy includes expanding its retrofitting

services and potentially developing new EVs. This dual approach aims to cater to individual consumers and business clients (B2B), as demonstrated through a strategic partnership with Exedy Clutch India, a subsidiary of a Japanese tech giant. This collaboration, involving a significant investment from Exedy, supports Starya's technological advancements and expansion plans in India and internationally.

However, Starya Mobility faces challenges, notably the lack of government subsidies for retrofitting, which affects its pricing competitiveness against subsidised new EVs. To counter this, they